

# Curriculum Vitae

Richárd Fejes

Richárd Fejes began his studies at Eötvös Loránd University (ELTE) in 2013, earning a B.A. in Liberal Arts (Media & Communication specialization; minor in Cultural Studies), followed by an M.A. in Literary and Cultural Studies (Comparative Literature). In 2018, he commenced his doctoral studies in the Comparative Literature program under the supervision of Gábor Tamás Molnár. His research focuses on transmedia storytelling and transmedial narratology, game studies, and alternate reality games (ARGs).

His list of publications outlines a trajectory that leads from the mediality of texts to a system-conscious transmedial narratology. His early work on the materiality of the book and the screen (still closely tied to his M.A. research project) appeared in 2019 in the volume *The Book Phenomenon in Cultural Space* under the title “Materiality and the Struggle Against the Screen: Survival of the Printed Literature.”

In 2021, together with co-editor Lilla Gregor and under the workshop leadership of László Bengi, he published the volume *Transzmédia: Interdiszciplináris tanulmányok* (Transmedia: Interdisciplinary Studies) – under Kijárat Kiadó – bringing together the work of members of the Transmedia student research group to attempt to institutionalize a Hungarian-language academic space for the field. This volume includes his study “A transzmédia-diskurzus” (The Transmedia Discourse), which provided a partial terminological and conceptual framework for his doctoral project.

Among his most significant articles is “Would You Stop Changing My Games? Stop Adding Lampposts to Them? (Az elbeszélő diskurzus struktúrái a videójátékokban)” (The Structures of Narrative Discourse in Video Games), which appeared in 2022 in the *Tiszatáj* journal’s game-studies special issue edited by Klaudia Jancsovics; its English version also appeared as a separate chapter in the Peter Lang volume *Multidisciplinary Perspectives on Narrative Aesthetics in Video Games*.

In 2024, he published “Secure, Contain, Protect: Az SCP Foundation transzmediális univerzumának jelenléte a videójáték médiumában” (The Presence of the SCP Foundation’s Transmedial Universe in the Medium of Video Games) in *Filológiai Közlöny*, edited by Zsófia Orosz-Réti. During this period, he also supported the activity of the Hungarian game-studies community by co-founding and organizing the Game Studies Hungary (GSH) academic mailing list with Klaudia Jancsovics.

Alongside his publications, Fejes has regularly presented his research to Hungarian and international audiences. Highlights include:

- 2018: the ICA pre-conference “Games Everywhere, Gaming Everywhere” in Prague, where he presented “How to Play This Story. Literature as Gaming Experience”;
- the same year, at the VIII Lisbon Summer School for the Study of Culture, he presented “Playing Literature: Blurring the Lines Between Gaming and Literature” before Marie-Laure Ryan;
- in Hungary at DH\_Budapest, the country’s largest digital humanities conference, he presented the poster “Typology and Topology of an Alternate Reality Game”;

- 2019: at the XXII Tavaszi Szél (Spring Wind) Conference, he presented “Transzmediális narratívarendszerek elemzése: kísérleti metodológia alternatív valóságjátékok vizsgálatára” (Analysis of Transmedial Narrative Systems: An Experimental Methodology for the Study of Alternate Reality Games) which even received a first prize;
- MOME (Moholy-Nagy University of Art and Design) hosted the Zip-Scene Conference on Immersive Storytelling twice, in 2020 and 2021, both of which he had the opportunity to present;
- and, among others, participated in the 2020 online workshop “Playfulness Across Media,” organized by Jan-Noël Thon, where he presented “Transmedia Narratives as Integrative and Social Platforms in Higher Education.”

Beyond academic work, he has also managed and created complex digital projects. From September 2021 to April 2023, he served as the project manager of the National Laboratory for Digital Heritage (DH-LAB), Hungary’s leading research and development center for digital humanities. Since April 2023, he has worked in parallel as a Game Producer at the game development company Play’n GO and as the Creative Director and Coordinator of EENJOY, an educational ARG and gamification platform established at ELTE. The dissertation also includes a short subchapter introducing EENJOY’s pedagogical aims and role.

Fejes is active in education beyond the university as well: at the Aranyelme Tehetséggondozó Egyesület, he teaches film theory and narratology to students in grades 3–6, and improv, drama, acting, film theory, and filmmaking to students in grades 6–12 – thus applying narratological study and results of his research in practice. Throughout his studies, he has received numerous recognitions, including twice winning the New National Excellence Program (ÚNKP) scholarship, achieving first place at the 2017 National Scientific Students’ Associations Conference (OTDK), and securing additional research scholarships.

His dissertation, *Narratologies of Transmedia Networks*, synthesizes this career path: it extends a structuralist toolkit to transmedial discourse and enriches it with the terminological, methodological, and theoretical results of related disciplines, making large-scale, network-like narrative systems more comprehensible, comparable, and interpretable. In doing so, it presents a narratological toolkit capable of keeping pace with the size and complexity of contemporary narratives.